HIGHER EDUCATION COMMISSION
PAKISTAN

Education Testing Council (ETC)

One Nation, One Standard, Equal Opportunity.

Assessment, Testing and Evaluation.

National Assessment · Standardization · Merit · Fairness

A national assessment platform supporting admissions, scholarships, recruitment, licensing and professional opportunities across Pakistan, the Sub-continent and the Middle East region.

2 million
Candidates tested
Since 2017

203
Test centres
In 40 cities

251,685
Calibrated test items
Continuously updated

TO ADVANCE QUALITY AND EQUITY IN EDUCATION THROUGH ASSESSMENTS FOR A BRIGHTER PAKISTAN

2026 Edition

“Assessment is not about proving what students know, but about improving what they learn.”

— Dylan Wiliam

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Inside this profile.

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Core values

Merit · Transparency · Fairness · Integrity · Quality · Innovation · Accountability

Opportunity begins with merit.

Welcome to the Education Testing Council

Behind every assessment is a person looking towards the next stage of life: a place at university, a scholarship, a profession or a new opportunity. ETC's work is to help make those decisions credible, consistent and fair.

Inside this profile

Explore the Council's purpose, leadership and services, followed by the assessments and methods that support its work. The final chapters explain quality assurance, secure operations, partnerships and the priorities guiding ETC's future.

> *Merit · Transparency · Fairness · Quality*

Education Testing Council
Higher Education Commission, Pakistan

Chairman's foreword.

"A fair test opens a door. Our responsibility is to ensure that it opens on the strength of merit."

Prof. Dr. Niaz Ahmed Akhtar (S.I)
Chairman Higher Education Commission Of Pakistan

The Education Testing Council (ETC), established under the auspices of the Higher Education Commission (HEC), plays an important role in advancing fair, reliable and transparent assessments in Pakistan. Its work supports merit-based access to education, scholarships, employment and professional opportunities.

For a candidate, a single test result can influence the course of a life. We must therefore treat every assessment as a public trust. Candidates should be judged on their knowledge and ability, regardless of their background or connections. Consistent procedures, secure examinations and sound test design are essential to upholding that trust.

ETC has developed into a national assessment platform serving universities, government departments, regulatory bodies and professional councils. The confidence placed in ETC by these institutions brings with it a responsibility to maintain the integrity of every assessment it conducts.

As we look ahead, HEC will support ETC in improving the quality of its questions, strengthening examination security and communicating more clearly with candidates. Continued investment in technology, research and skilled people will help ETC respond to changing needs while maintaining the reliability, validity and fairness of its assessments.

I commend the ETC team and its partner institutions for their work. Together, we can build a culture in which opportunity follows merit and every candidate can have confidence in the result they receive.

Strategic direction.

“Strengthening assessment through integrity, innovation, standardization and excellent service.”

Meritorious Prof. Dr Zia ul Haq (S.I)

Executive Director, Higher Education Commission of Pakistan

The Higher Education Commission established the Education Testing Council to give Pakistan a credible, professionally managed and self-sustaining national testing body. Our aim is straightforward: access to higher education and professional opportunities should be decided by merit, through processes that are open, consistent and trusted.

Institutions need tests that are standardized, secure and quick to report; candidates need clear information and fair treatment. ETC responds by combining sound measurement methods with appropriate technology. Every stage is guided by evidence and checked for quality.

We will continue to build institutional confidence through good governance, professional capacity, secure examinations and timely results. Collaboration with universities, public-sector organizations, employers and professional bodies will help make assessment more accessible, efficient and responsive.

Strategic priorities

Excellence	Reliable, well-designed assessments.
Integrity	Credible examinations and secure delivery.
Digital transformation	Technology-enabled tests and candidate services.
Confidence	Transparent, responsive stakeholder relationships.
Capacity	Professional standards, governance and improvement.

Leadership navigation.

“Building confidence in assessment by placing merit, integrity and the candidate experience at the heart of everything we do.”

Dr. Muhammad Imtiaz Haider

Chief Executive Officer, Education Testing Council

Chief Executive Officer · Education Testing Council

At ETC, we hold ourselves to one simple principle: every candidate deserves a test that is fair, transparent, secure and consistent. Whether a young person is applying to a law college, a scholarship holder is entering a PhD programme, or a professional is seeking a licence, they should be able to trust that the result reflects their own ability.

To make this possible, we have built our work on professional standards and operational discipline. Each question in our item bank is written by trained subject experts, reviewed by several committees, tried out on real candidates and analysed statistically before it is used to make decisions. After every live test, we study the results again, so that weak or unclear questions are corrected or removed. This cycle of checking and improving is what gives our scores their meaning.

Technology is an important partner in this effort. We use automated paper generation from a calibrated item bank, optical scanning for fast and accurate marking, and online services for registration and results. As we move forward, we plan a gradual shift to computer-based testing, stronger identity verification and smarter monitoring, always with careful safeguards for data protection and confidentiality.

Our responsibility does not end with conducting examinations. We work closely with institutions to help them identify talent and make sound decisions. We listen to candidates, answer their concerns and treat complaints seriously. We believe a testing body must earn trust through its actions: open processes, accountable governance, responsive service and a culture of quality.

I thank our Board of Governors, the Higher Education Commission, our subject experts and the entire ETC team for their commitment. Together, we will continue to grow ETC into an institution that Pakistan can rely on for fair and meaningful assessment.

About ETC.

ETC, mandate and direction.

A national assessment platform

The Education Testing Council is Pakistan’s public-sector national testing body, working under the Higher Education Commission. It provides standardized, centralized and secure assessments for education and professional opportunities.

The Council supports candidates, universities, scholarship programmes, government departments and regulatory bodies. Its work brings test design, item development, secure delivery, scoring and reporting into one assessment system.

Our record in numbers

2 million	Candidates tested since 2017
203 centres · 40 cities	National network, with capacity of about 100,000 candidates in a shift
251,685	Calibrated items in a continuously updated bank
261 projects · 1,750 papers	Tests delivered for clients, with distinct papers and no repetition
850 blueprints · 802 batteries	Blueprints developed and test batteries piloted
530 subject experts	Expertise available across subject areas

VISION

Be the enabler for coming generations of students to unlock their true potential in service of the nation, as well as help establish and ensure meritocracy at all levels of education, public service and professional endeavor through uncompromising commitment to equity and fairness in all our efforts.

MISSION

To advance quality and equity in education, public service and professional endeavour throughout the nation by making such prudent decisions possible that are informed by core values of quality, integrity and equal opportunity.

Governance, values and services.

CORE VALUES

Merit	Opportunity based on ability and performance.
Transparency	Clear, accountable and understandable processes.
Fairness	Impartial assessment for every candidate.
Integrity	Ethical conduct and protection of assessment credibility.
Quality	Consistent standards and continuous improvement.
Innovation	Responsible use of technology and modern assessment practices.
Accountability	Ownership, governance and responsible service delivery.

Oversight and accountability

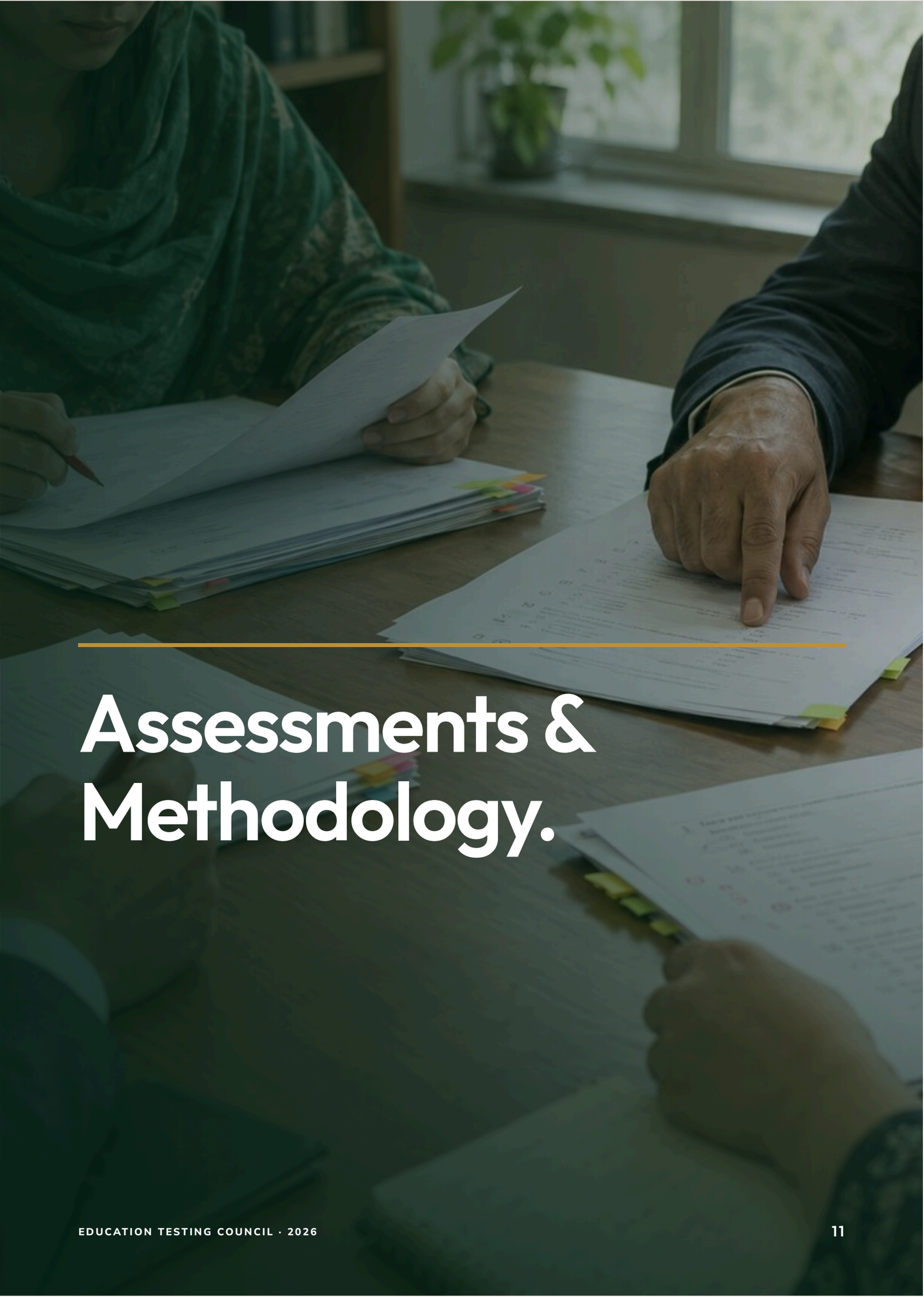
The Board of Governors sets direction and provides oversight. The Chief Executive Officer leads the Council. Internal Audit reports independently; the Secretariat provides technical, legal, financial and administrative advice.

Five functional groups

Quality Assurance	Monitoring, evaluation, collaboration and certification.
Academics & Research	Question bank, training, research and analytics.
Operations & Technology	Test delivery, technology, printing and candidate support.
Administration	People, finance, infrastructure and logistics.
Business Development	Marketing, media and institutional relationships.

Services for institutions

ETC supports admissions, scholarships, recruitment, promotion, screening and professional assessment. Clients can use an integrated process from requirement study and blueprint development through secure administration, scoring, analysis and reporting.



Assessments & Methodology.

Assessment portfolio and legal tests.

The ETC assessment portfolio

LAT	Undergraduate law admissions.
LAW-GAT	Law graduates seeking enrolment as advocates.
HAT-General	MS/MPhil admissions and scholarship eligibility.
HAAT-Subject	Doctoral admissions and subject achievement.
NSCT	National Skill Competency Test for Computing & IT Graduates
USAT	Undergraduate admissions and scholarships.
Customized tests	Recruitment, screening and client-specific selection.

LAT · Law Admission Test

LAT is mandatory for admission to five-year LLB programmes in public and private universities and law colleges, following the Supreme Court's directions on legal education reform. It assesses reasoning, language, general knowledge and written expression. Students completing intermediate / HSSC or equivalent take the test; it is held twice a year. The listed fee is Rs. 2,000.

LAW-GAT · Law Graduate Assessment Test

LAW-GAT assesses core legal knowledge and its application for LLB graduates seeking enrolment with a provincial Bar Council. A pass result is required for enrolment as an advocate. It is held quarterly across Pakistan; the listed fee is Rs. 3,000. Accuracy around the passing score is particularly important.

National Skill Competency Test (NSCT) for Computing & IT Graduates

The NSCT is a standardized national-level assessment for 7th and 8th semester students in Computer Science and IT-related degree programmes at Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) across Pakistan. It assesses the application of technical knowledge, problem-solving skills and professional competencies to practical scenarios and real-world industry requirements.

Purpose and objectives: Assess industry readiness; identify gaps between academic preparation, practical skills and market requirements; benchmark graduate competencies across institutions; strengthen academia–industry linkages for relevant curricula and practical learning; and enhance employability through targeted skills development, industry engagement, internships and employment pathways.

Test validity

LAT	HAT	USAT	LAW-GAT
2 years	2 years	1 year	Lifetime

Postgraduate assessments.

HAT-General

The Higher Education Aptitude Test supports postgraduate study at MS and MPhil level and HEC scholarship eligibility. Five categories group candidates by broad field so that assessment takes place in a context close to their discipline.

Who should take it	Graduates holding a 16-year degree or equivalent seeking MS/MPhil study.
What it measures	Verbal, quantitative and analytical reasoning.
How results are used	Universities and HEC use scores for eligibility and ranking for admission or scholarships.
Listed fee	Rs. 2,000

HAAT-Subject

The Higher Education Aptitude & Achievement Test is designed for candidates moving towards doctoral study. It combines general aptitude with achievement in the candidate's subject.

Who should take it	Holders of an MS/MPhil or equivalent 18-year qualification applying for PhD programmes.
What it measures	Advanced reasoning and in-depth subject knowledge, reviewed by subject committees.
How results are used	Eligibility and merit decisions for PhD admissions and HEC scholarships.
Listed fee	Rs. 3,000

Relevant content, comparable decisions

The two products serve different academic stages. General aptitude supports readiness for postgraduate study; subject achievement adds evidence about preparation for doctoral work. Institutions use the relevant assessment within their published admission and scholarship rules.

Undergraduate admission testing.

USAT: common core and subject knowledge

USAT is a standardized test for undergraduate admissions and HEC undergraduate scholarships. Six categories match candidates' intermediate streams, combining a common aptitude core with discipline-specific knowledge.

Part I comprises 75 MCQs: 20 Verbal Reasoning, 25 Quantitative Reasoning and 30 discipline-specific questions. Part II carries 25 marks: an argument-based essay (15) and a narrative essay (10), each chosen from three options.

Six categories

USAT-E · Pre-engineering	Physics 10 · Chemistry 10 · Mathematics 10
USAT-M · Pre-medical	Physics 8 · Chemistry 8 · Biology 14
USAT-CS · Computer science	Physics 8 · Computer Science 14 · Mathematics 8
USAT-GS · General science	Mathematics 10 · Statistics 10 · Economics 10
USAT-COM · Commerce	Accounting 10 · Commerce 10 · Economics 10
USAT-A · Arts and humanities	Islamiat/Ethics 10 · Pakistan Studies 10 · General Knowledge 10

What the test assesses

The discipline component covers foundational concepts, subject knowledge and applied problem-solving. Verbal and quantitative reasoning assess general cognitive aptitude. The essays assess organization, argument, expression and written communication.

The Table of Specifications balances content with thinking levels, using Bloom's Taxonomy from knowledge and understanding through application and analysis. This makes the intended coverage explicit before the paper is assembled.

From a brief to a test.

Customized assessment

Beyond its national products, ETC builds tests for government departments, regulators, universities and projects. These include recruitment, specific cadres, admissions and screening. Every assignment starts with the selection purpose and the knowledge or skills the client needs to assess.

A controlled development process

1–3 · Plan	Define requirements, agree the blueprint and Table of Specifications, and identify the content and thinking levels.
4–6 · Develop	Commission items, review them with subject and technical experts, and check language, clarity and fairness.
7–9 · Validate	Pilot questions, analyse their statistical properties, and revise or replace weak items.
10–11 · Assemble	Select calibrated items to match the blueprint, generate the paper and complete final quality checks.
12–13 · Deliver and review	Administer securely, score and report results, then analyse live-test evidence to improve the bank.

Scoring and reporting

MCQs are processed through standardized scoring; written responses use scoring rubrics and checking procedures. Client reporting presents the results and supporting analysis needed for the agreed selection purpose.

The feedback loop continues after delivery. Psychometric and subject experts examine item performance and document whether questions should be retained, revised or critically reviewed.

Same standard, every time

A customized test follows the same blueprint, review, piloting and analysis principles as the national products. The format can change with the purpose; the commitment to quality and fairness remains.

Blueprints, items and the bank.

Start with the blueprint

A blueprint, or Table of Specifications, defines what a test will cover, how many questions each area receives and which thinking levels are required. It links the purpose of the assessment to the questions that appear in the paper.

Bloom’s Taxonomy helps balance knowledge, understanding, application, analysis, evaluation and creation. The blueprint prevents a paper from becoming an accidental collection of available questions.

Good practice in item writing

A clear task	Use plain language, a focused question and sufficient information.
A defensible answer	Make the key correct and the distractors plausible.
Relevant content	Match the syllabus, intended skill and thinking level.
Fair context	Avoid bias, stereotypes, unnecessary complexity and clues to the answer.
Expert review	Check content, technical quality, language and fairness before use.

The ETC item bank

The item bank is a secure academic resource containing 251,685 calibrated test items. It allows the Council to assemble different but equivalent papers, avoid repeating questions and respond to client requirements.

Items are organized by subject and linked to their content area, thinking level and statistical properties. The twelve listed subject banks together hold 188,310 items; the overall total covers all banks. Calibration, tagging and continued review keep the resource useful as it grows.

Calibration, analysis and security.

Calibration and piloting

Calibration measures item difficulty and other properties so questions can be placed on a common scale. Items are tagged by subject, topic, thinking level and review history. Piloting provides evidence before an item is used for decisions.

Security of the bank

Access	Restrict access to authorized staff and the functions their role requires.
Preparation	Generate papers and handle confidential materials in controlled conditions.
Traceability	Record selection, review and use; protect data throughout delivery and scoring.

Item-level analysis

Difficulty	The p-value is the proportion answering correctly; judge it against the intended test difficulty.
Discrimination	Use corrected item–total correlation and upper–lower comparisons to examine separation of stronger and weaker candidates.
Distractors	Review option choices; options selected by fewer than 5% are non-functioning.
Rasch fit	The preferred Infit / Outfit mean-square range is 0.7–1.3.
Response patterns	Investigate blanks, invalid responses and possible miskeys.

Fairness and post-test review

DIF checks whether equally able candidates from different groups perform differently on an item. Mantel–Haenszel A/B/C classifications guide screening; category C items receive independent review. After live delivery, psychometric and subject experts review unexpected patterns and decide whether items should be retained, revised or critically reviewed.

The item life cycle and measurement.

An ongoing improvement cycle

Develop and review	Write items to the blueprint; check content, language, technical quality and fairness.
Pilot and calibrate	Gather responses, analyse performance and establish item properties.
Store and select	Tag approved items and assemble papers to the required specification.
Administer and analyse	Deliver securely and review live-test evidence.
Retain, revise or review	Document decisions, improve weak items and test revisions before reuse.

The psychometric report

After every test, ETC prepares a report on candidate results and item performance. It asks whether the paper measured ability accurately, consistently and fairly, and how each item contributed to that measurement.

Classical Test Theory works with observed scores. The Rasch / one-parameter logistic (1PL) model places candidate ability and item difficulty on a common scale measured in logits. The probability of success depends on the gap between ability and difficulty.

Targeting and separation

A person–item, or Wright, map plots abilities and item difficulties together. Gaps show where coverage is too easy, too hard or thin. Reliability and separation show how consistently a test measures and how well it distinguishes ability levels.

The report combines these measures with item-level review so that improvements can be directed to the parts of the test where they are most useful.

Precision and review decisions

The Test Information Function and Conditional SEM show where a test measures most precisely and where uncertainty is greater. Item characteristic curves and Wright maps help assess difficulty and targeting.

Item review considers discrimination, distractor functioning, response patterns and Rasch fit (preferred Infit / Outfit range 0.7–1.3). Experts decide whether to retain, revise or critically review each item; flags do not trigger automatic deletion.

Reliability and validity.

Reliable, valid and fair decisions

Reliability concerns consistency: a candidate should receive similar results when the same ability is measured under comparable conditions. Validity concerns the evidence supporting the interpretation and intended use of those results. Fairness concerns equal opportunity to demonstrate ability.

Types of reliability

Internal consistency	KR-20 and Cronbach's alpha examine how consistently items contribute to a test score.
Test–retest	Checks score stability over time when ability is expected to remain comparable.
Parallel forms	Examines consistency across different versions designed to measure the same ability.
Inter-rater	Checks agreement between markers of written or practical responses.
Measurement error	SEM expresses the uncertainty around an individual score and helps avoid false precision.

Sources of validity evidence

Content	Blueprints and expert review check coverage of the intended knowledge and skills.
Construct	The assessment should measure the intended ability rather than unrelated factors.
Criterion relationships	Relationships with relevant external outcomes can support the intended interpretation.
Consequences and use	Selection rules and score use should match the purpose for which evidence was gathered.

Interpreting the evidence

No single coefficient proves that a test is suitable for every decision. Reliability, content review, statistical analysis and the context of use must be considered together, particularly around a passing or selection score.

Fairness throughout the process

Fairness means that scores depend on the knowledge and skills being assessed, rather than unrelated personal or social factors. ETC checks content for bias, uses DIF analysis, applies standardized administration and scoring, and provides reasonable arrangements on request. Candidates can raise concerns through published support and hearing procedures.

Evidence and responsible score use.

Evidence suited to the decision

LAT	Blueprint and language/content review support legal-study entry; consistent scoring supports comparable admission decisions.
LAW-GAT	Core-law coverage, standard setting and evidence around the pass score support licensing decisions.
HAT-General	Section and total-score reliability, category alignment and comparability support postgraduate selection.
HAAT-Subject	Subject committees, advanced-content coverage and analysis support doctoral admission use.
USAT	Stream-specific coverage, the common core and rubric-based essays support undergraduate selection.
Customized tests	The agreed purpose, blueprint, review and analysis support the client's particular selection task.

Reliability, validity and fairness together

ETC examines consistency of scores, alignment with the intended knowledge and skills, and the opportunity for candidates to demonstrate ability fairly. DIF review, standardized conditions and documented scoring procedures contribute to that evidence.

Relevant statistics include KR-20 / alpha, SEM and evidence about equivalence across forms. The choice of evidence depends on the assessment and the decision being made.

Responsible interpretation

A test score is an estimate with a margin of error. Small score differences should not be given more meaning than the evidence supports. Scores should be used for the purpose for which the test was designed, alongside the institution's published selection rules.

Passing scores and ranking decisions need particular care. Reporting should explain results clearly and avoid presenting a score as a complete description of a candidate's ability or potential.

Quality & Operations.

Quality standards and review.

Quality throughout the assessment

ETC's quality framework covers test design, question development, expert review, secure administration, scoring and reporting. Checks occur at several stages so that responsibility for quality is shared across the assessment process.

Expert committees

Content and subject review	Checks correctness, relevance and subject coverage against the blueprint.
Technical review	Examines item structure, keys, distractors and assessment design.
Language review	Checks clarity, expression and language appropriate to the candidates.
Fairness review	Looks for bias, stereotypes and context unrelated to the ability being tested.
Final review	Confirms paper readiness and the resolution of issues identified earlier.

Evidence before and after use

Piloting and psychometric analysis support item selection. After administration, live-response evidence supports review of the whole paper and individual questions. Problems can be referred for revision, specialist investigation or a documented scoring decision.

The framework connects subject expertise with statistical evidence: neither is treated as a substitute for the other.

Continuous improvement

Quality assurance monitors the procedures that produce a reliable result as well as the result itself. Findings feed back into item-writing guidance, training, bank maintenance and operational practice.

Assurance, security and scoring.

Independent checks at several stages

Quality Assurance monitors test operations, paper development, printing and result generation. Multi-dimensional review brings content, technical, language and fairness perspectives to the same assessment.

Monitoring before, during and after delivery connects preparation, administration and follow-up. Findings inform both immediate action and improvements to later tests.

Security from bank to result

Item and paper preparation	Control access, document review and manage paper generation in a secure environment.
Printing and movement	Protect confidential materials and keep their handling traceable.
At the centre	Apply identity checks, standardized instructions, timing and monitoring.
Collection and processing	Count, seal and return answer sheets securely before scanning and scoring.
Unfair-means cases	Use documented procedures and give candidates a fair hearing.

Consistent scoring

MCQs use machine processing and checking procedures. Descriptive answers are marked with rubrics so that the same standard is applied across candidates. Statistical analysis checks the performance of both items and the test.

Potential miskeys, weak items and unusual results are referred for investigation. Decisions about faulty questions should be applied consistently to affected candidates.

Improving the quality system

Documented procedures, professional review and progress towards recognized quality standards support the Council’s institutional development and its commitment to trusted results.

Test operations and reach.

A coordinated national network

ETC operates through 203 test centres in 40 cities, with capacity for about 100,000 candidates in a shift. National delivery depends on coordinated planning, trained staff, secure materials and standardized instructions.

The test-day journey

Registration	Candidates register, pay online and receive an admit card with centre, date and time.
Arrival and identity	Staff verify the admit card and identity document.
Seating and instructions	Candidates follow the seating plan and receive standard instructions.
Administration	Sealed papers are opened in front of candidates and timing is observed.
Collection and scanning	Answer sheets are counted, sealed, returned securely and scanned.
Results	Scores are analysed and results are published and shared with client institutions.

Operations responsibilities

The Test Operations Department plans venues and schedules, coordinates staffing and logistics, supports candidate communication and manages secure movement of materials. Monitoring and reporting help identify and resolve issues during administration.

International administration

ETC also conducts tests abroad in cooperation with Pakistan’s embassies. Its international experience includes the United Arab Emirates, Saudi Arabia, Afghanistan, Bangladesh and Sri Lanka.

Our commitment to candidates.

Transparent information and fair treatment

Candidates should understand the assessment before they sit it. ETC publishes the test purpose, format, syllabus, timing, fees and rules, and works to make registration, communication and result reporting clear.

Questions are checked for fairness and statistical quality. Reasonable arrangements can be requested for disabilities or special needs. Scores and personal data are handled confidentially, and results are issued through the published process.

What ETC expects

Prepare	Read the published rules, syllabus, admit-card instructions and test-day requirements.
Arrive ready	Bring the required identity document and admit card, and arrive on time.
Follow the rules	Observe instructions, timing and permitted-material requirements.
Work honestly	Do your own work and avoid unfair means.
Respect others	Help maintain a calm, fair environment for every candidate.

How we remain accountable

Published rules	Candidates can see the conditions under which the test is conducted.
Communication channels	The helpline and online portal provide support and a route for concerns.
Unfair-means hearings	Cases follow a documented process with an opportunity to be heard.
Post-test review	Statistical and operational findings inform improvements.
Oversight	Audit and governance arrangements support institutional accountability.

Strategic roadmap.

Our direction

ETC aims to become a fully digital, research-led and internationally certified national testing body that every candidate and institution in Pakistan can trust. Its institutional priorities connect better tools with stronger people, evidence and services.

Priorities for the years ahead

Digital transformation	Strengthen technology across test development, delivery, candidate services and reporting.
Research and innovation	Use assessment research and psychometric evidence to improve tests and decisions.
Quality and certification	Strengthen standards, quality systems and progress towards international certification.
Institutional capacity	Develop professional skills, governance and the systems needed for sustained growth.
Stakeholder confidence	Improve communication and responsiveness to candidates, partners and clients.

An assessment system that earns trust

Progress is measured by the quality of the whole process: useful questions, secure delivery, consistent scoring, fair treatment and clear results. Technology supports these aims alongside professional judgement and documented review.

Assessment glossary.

Blueprint / Table of Specifications (TOS)

The plan of a test: which topics, how many questions, and at which thinking levels.

Bloom's Taxonomy

A way of classifying thinking from simple recall up to creating new ideas.

Item

A single test question, together with its answer options and key.

Item bank

A secure database of reviewed and calibrated items, with their statistics.

Calibration

Measuring an item's difficulty and other properties so it can be placed on a common scale.

Pre-test / piloting

Trying out new items on a sample of students before using them for real decisions.

Post-hoc analysis

Statistical review of items and the whole test after a live administration.

Difficulty index (p-value)

The proportion of candidates who answer an item correctly.

Discrimination index

How well an item separates stronger from weaker candidates.

Distractor

A wrong answer option in an MCQ.

DIF

Differential Item Functioning: a check of whether equally able candidates from different groups perform differently on an item.

Reliability

The consistency of test scores.

Assessment glossary — continued.

KR-20 / Cronbach's alpha

Statistics that measure the internal consistency (reliability) of a test.

SEM

Standard Error of Measurement: the likely margin of error around an individual score.

Validity

The degree to which evidence supports the meaning and use of test scores.

Equating

A statistical method that makes scores on different versions of a test comparable.

Rubric

A fixed scoring guide used to mark written or practical answers consistently.

OMR

Optical Mark Recognition: machine scanning of answer sheets.

CBT

Computer-Based Testing.

IRT

Item Response Theory: a modern statistical model for analysing and calibrating items.

Rasch / 1PL model

An IRT model in which the chance of a correct answer depends only on the gap between candidate ability and item difficulty.

Logit

The unit of the Rasch scale on which both ability and difficulty are measured.

Infit / Outfit

Rasch fit statistics showing whether responses to an item follow the expected pattern (preferred range 0.7 – 1.3).

Wright map

A chart that places candidate abilities and item difficulties side by side to show targeting.

Fairness

Equal opportunity for every candidate to show their ability, with scores free of factors unrelated to the test's purpose.

Our Clients.

01	Supreme Court of Pakistan.
02	Gilgit Baltistan Chief Court, Public Sector/Judicial Institution
03	Election Commission Gilgit Baltistan.
04	National AML / CFT Recruitment Tests
05	Federal Ombudsman/Wafaqi Mohtasib Secretariat Recruitment
06	Ministry of Federal Education & Professional Training, Government of Pakistan. (Daanish Schools Authority)
07	Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University (SZABMU)(MDCAT)
08	Pakistan Infrastructure Development Company Limited (PIDCL)
09	Federal Directorate of Education
10	Balochistan Public Procurement Regulatory Authority (BPPRA)
11	GB Board of Revenue
12	NAVTTAC
13	GB Police Recruitment Tests
14	GB Health Department
15	HEC (HRM and HRD Divisions)
16	Rawalpindi Women University
17	Emerson University Multan
18	Interim Placement of Fresh PhDs (IPFP)
19	University of Karachi
20	University of Mianwali
21	Shah Abdul Latif University, Kahirpur
22	Pakistan Social Protection Authority (PSPA)
23	University of Education Lahore
24	University of Loralai

Our Clients — continued.

25	University of Turbat
26	University of Layyah
27	Allama Iqbal Open University(AIOU)
28	University of Baltistan
29	University of Haripur
30	University of Haveli Kahuta AJK
31	National Curriculum Council
32	Fatima Jinnah Women University
33	Drug Regulatory Authority of Pakistan (DRAP)
34	Ministry of Defence Production Pakistan (MODP)
35	Chief Minister’s Inspection Team Balochistan (CMIT)
36	University Of Makran Panjgur.Balochistan
37	University of Engineering and Technology,Taxila
38	Balochistan Residential College (BRC)
39	Quaid-i-Azam University,Islamabad(Under Graduate Admission Test)
40	PMU-BESP (Project/Education Sector)
41	Balochistan Education Endowment Fund -(BEEF) Scholarship (LLM and Bar at LAW)
42	BALFATA Scholarship
43	Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University SZABMU-MDCAT (Soudi Arab & Dubai)
44	Afghan Student-Scholarship
45	Sri-Lanka Student -Scholarship
46	Bangaladash Scholarship
47	BRC Zhob
48	BRC Khuzdar

Confidence in assessment. Opportunity through merit.

A shared public trust

Assessment connects individual ambition with institutional decisions. That responsibility calls for clear test purposes, sound questions, secure delivery, reliable scoring and fair treatment of every candidate.

A connected system

ETC brings these elements together through expert review, a calibrated item bank, psychometric analysis and coordinated operations. Its partnerships with institutions support selection for education, scholarships, employment and professional pathways.

Looking ahead

The Council’s direction is to strengthen technology, research, professional capacity and quality systems. Continued improvement—and clear communication with candidates and partners—will help sustain confidence in the results.

> *Every assessment should support a decision that candidates and institutions can trust.*

Education Testing Council (ETC)

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